



Sandwich

DIET ANALYSIS: CUBAN IGUANA (*CYCLURA NUBILA NUBILA*)

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Summer 2026

SPECIES BACKGROUND



1. Range

2. Habitat

3. What is it?

4. Conservation status

1. Cuba, Isla de la Juventud, and surrounding Cuban cays/islets
2. Rocky coastal areas, limestone refuges, coastal scrub, mangroves, and sandy shore vegetation
3. Large diurnal iguanian lizard; a West Indian rock iguana in genus *Cyclura*; opportunistic herbivore
4. IUCN/FWS: Vulnerable / federally threatened; still one of the more common rock iguanas

SANDWICH BACKGROUND



1. ID / body condition

2. Current husbandry

3. Diet behavior

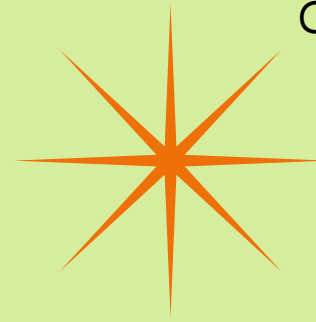
4. Other Observations

1. 1.0 Cuban iguana; ~9 lb; estimated 10–15 years old; body condition appears good.
2. Fed M/W/F; enclosure is misted and adjusted for temperature; most basking occurs before noon.
3. Currently consumes ~99%; prefers fruits primarily., encouraged to forage
4. Nasal salt-gland excretion common in iguanas.

WILD DIET ANALYSIS

- Generalist/opportunistic herbivore: Mainly leaves, fruits, flowers, grasses, and locally available vegetation.
- Some natural plant items: Cocoplum, saltwort, buttonwood, seagrass, grasses, and Metopium toxiferum fruit.
- Seasonal fruit consumption: Cayo Sijú June scat: 96.7% contained Chrysobalanus icaco fruit. In June, fruit was the single most frequent item.
- Documented animal matter: Palomo scat: 45% dragonfly remains, 5% crab parts; Gerber documented forceful carrion feeding on a dove nestling.
- Breakdown: Plants dominate overall, fruit may become seasonally dominant, and animal matter is minor but diverse/opportunistic.

Common items for Wild Iguana



Batis maritima
(saltwort leaves)



Chrysobalanus icaco
(cocoplum fruit)



Conocarpus / Corchorus
(buttonwood / herbs)



Thalassia / Setaria
(seagrass / grasses)



Dragonflies, crabs



ZOOTAMPA DIET ANALYSIS

- **Current offered diet**

M/W/F: 150g chopped mixed greens, 50g squash/sweet potato/carrot, 1/8 cup minced fruit

- **Mixed greens (~65% of ZDN as-fed avg)**

Escarole, endive, collards, romaine, bok choy, green leaf, red leaf, dandelion

- **Vegetables (~25% of ZDN as-fed avg)**

Squash, sweet potato, carrot

- **Fruit chunk (~10% of ZDN as-fed avg)**

Minced separately; Contains amounts of apple, pear, blueberry, cantaloupe, honeydew, papaya

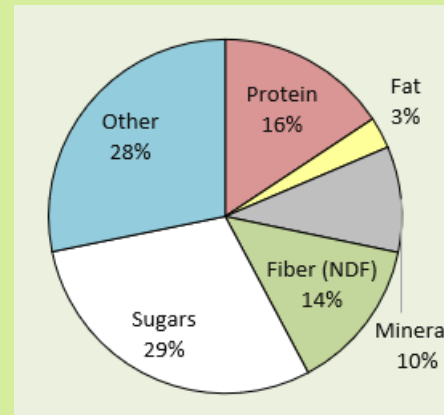
- **Browse**

Offered ~1x/week; mulberry preferred

- **Supplements**

Supplements every couple weeks. Following items are rotated: Miner-All, Calcium + LoD, Vitamin A + Miner-All, ReptiCal w/D3;

- **Variable Keeper Added Enrichment such as banana/hornworm/etc**



Mixed greens



Fruit chunk



Browse



Banana / hornworm



Miner-All / calcium / D3



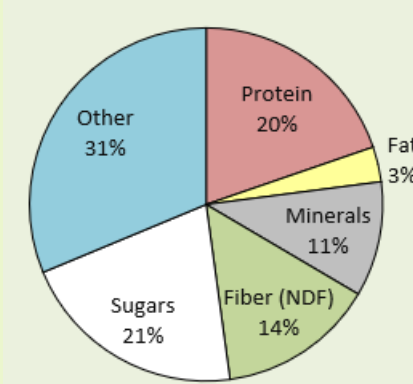
Other Captive Diets

Lincoln Zoo (Cuban)	Avg g/day	Diet notes	Compared with Sandwich
Total	106.6	produce-based	closest match
Greens	79.9	collard, green leaf, romaine, spring mix	less variety
Veg + fruit	26.7	carrot, sweet potato, squash + fruit	same core veg; lower fruit
Supplement	A sprinkle	calcium powder over salad	more frequent Ca

Miami Zoo / Jamaican iguana	Avg g/day	Diet notes	Compared with Sandwich
Total	126.6	produce + Mazuri LS	higher kcal/DM
Greens/veg/fruit	117.6	collard, romaine, kale, fruit/veg	different profile
Supplement/feed	0.28g (0.4 per feed day)	ReptiCalcium w/D3 each feed + Mazuri	more D3/feed input

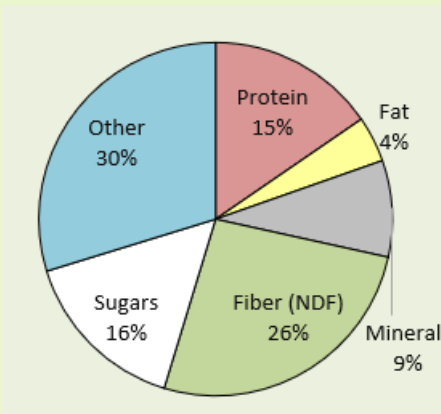
Lincoln Zoo

- Cuban rock iguana diet: greens, vegetables, fruit
- Closest direct comparison to Sandwich
- Similar calories, slightly higher protein
- Calcium supplement sprinkled daily over salad



Miami Zoo / Jamaican Iguana

- **NOT a direct species comparison**
- Includes Mazuri Tortoise Low-Starch
- ReptiCalcium w/D3: 0.4g per animal/feed day
- Higher calories, protein, fiber, and D3



NUTRITION COMPARISON

ZDN caveats:

- No Cuban iguana requirement profile available
- Browse, supplements, and rare keeper-added items are not accounted for in this chart
- Best use: compare broad trends between diets



Metric	ZooTampa	Lincoln	Miami/Jamaican
As-fed g/day	98.6	106.6	126.6
Energy kcal/day	28.6	27.5	67.8
Dry matter g/day	8.4	8.1	20.8
Protein g/day	1.32	1.59	3.21
Fiber (NDF) g/day	1.17	1.16	5.47
Ca:P	2.11:1	1.44:1	2.19:1
Outlier	lower protein High sugar	closest match	Mazuri + high energy

WHAT WE CAN CONCLUDE

1. Compared with captive diets

2. Compared with wild diets

3. Main limitation

4. Overall conclusion

1. ZooTampa and Lincoln are very similar; Sandwich is slightly lower in protein than Lincoln, while Miami/Jamaican is the major outlier because of Mazuri and higher energy/fiber.
2. Wild sources suggest more seasonal fruit and occasional animal matter than the current base diet; Sandwich's browse and foraging presentation still make the diet more naturalistic.
3. ZDN is useful for side-by-side trends, but not for proving requirements without a Cuban iguana profile; browse, supplements, and keeper additions are not fully captured.
4. Supplements are more varied at ZooTampa, but appear less frequent/less standardized than Lincoln's daily calcium and Miami's ReptiCalcium w/D3 each feed day.

- Keep base diet **mostly intact**; no major regular item looks clearly inappropriate.
- Increase **seasonal fruit variety** and possibly quantity in a controlled way, since wild Cuban iguanas may eat fruit heavily during some seasons. (**can outnumber leaf material** in some wild samples) Wild fruits are less **sugar dense** than grocery counterparts so **caution** advised.
- Clarify/standardize supplement rotation and document the **reason for frequency**.
- Consider rare animal-based enrichment only with veterinary approval: insects/hornworms first; even crayfish/crab or chick could be rare enrichment based on **wild diet data**.
- Do not add Mazuri/Complete feeds unless ZDN or staff review suggests a specific nutrient gap.



SUGGESTIONS/ POSSIBLE DIETARY CHANGES



THANKYOU!

This concludes my Internship Diet Analysis Project.



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Lincoln Children's Zoo, Miami Zoo, and ZooTampa internal diet sheets / ZDN analyses.